

Project Overview

Project Title

FoodBridge: Food Rescue & Donation Platform

Project Description

FoodBridge is a web-based platform designed to connect food donors, NGOs, and volunteers in order to reduce food waste and help people facing food insecurity. The platform enables donors to post surplus food, NGOs to request food, and volunteers to coordinate pickups and deliveries.

Project Goal

The primary goal of FoodBridge is to create an efficient and transparent food donation ecosystem that minimizes food waste and ensures surplus food reaches those in need.

Problem Statement

Food waste is a major social and environmental issue. Restaurants, hotels, and event organizers often dispose of large amounts of edible surplus food. At the same time, many individuals and communities struggle to access sufficient food.

Current food donation processes are mostly manual, relying on phone calls, personal contacts, or social media. These methods are inefficient, lack transparency, and often result in missed donation opportunities.

FoodBridge addresses this problem by providing a centralized platform that connects food donors, NGOs, and volunteers, enabling efficient food collection, distribution, and tracking.

Target Users

- Restaurants
- Hotels
- Event Organizers
- NGOs
- Volunteers
- Administrators

Expected Benefits

- Reduction of food waste

- Improved food accessibility
- Better coordination among stakeholders
- Real-time tracking of donations

Stakeholder Analysis:

stakeholder	Role in System	Needs/Expectations	Benefits Received
Donors (Restaurants, Hotels, Event Organizers, Individuals)	Donate surplus food	Easy donation process, transparency, quick pickup	Reduced food waste, social responsibility fulfillment
NGOs / Charitable Organization	Request and distribute food	Real-time access to available food donations	Reliable food supply for beneficiaries
Volunteers	Collect and deliver food	Clear delivery assignments and location information	Opportunity to contribute to society
Beneficiaries (People in Need)	Receive donated food	Timely and safe food distribution	Access to free food assistance
System Administrator	Manage platform operations	Monitoring tools, user management, reporting	Efficient platform control and security
Government Agencies	Monitor social welfare initiatives	Transparency and compliance information	Transparency and compliance information
Food Safety Authorities	Ensure food quality and safety	Information about food expiry and handling	Improved food safety standards

Local Communities	Indirect beneficiaries	Reduced food waste and improved social welfare	Cleaner environment and stronger community support
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Stakeholder Priority Matrix :

Priority Level	Stakeholders
High Priority	Donors, NGOs, System Administrators
Medium Priority	Volunteers, Beneficiaries, Government Agencies
Low Priority	Food Safety Authorities, Local Communities

Information Gathering:

Sources Used

1. NGO Websites
2. Food Bank Organizations
3. Research Articles on Food Waste
4. Interviews with Restaurant Owners
5. Discussions with Volunteers
6. Online Surveys

Findings

- Significant quantities of food are wasted daily.
- NGOs struggle to identify food donors quickly.
- Volunteers need a structured delivery system.
- Real-time communication improves donation success rates.
- Existing solutions lack transparency and tracking features.

Conclusion

A centralized digital platform can significantly improve food donation efficiency and reduce food waste.

Interview:

Interview 1: Restaurant Owner

Question:

What happens to surplus food at the end of the day?

Response:

Most surplus food is discarded because there is no quick way to find organizations that need it.

Question:

Would you use a food donation platform?

Response:

Yes, if it is simple and reliable.

Interview 2: NGO Representative

Question:

What is your biggest challenge in food collection?

Response:

Finding available food donations on time.

Question:

Would real-time notifications help?

Response:

Yes, it would improve our response time significantly.

Interview 3: Volunteer

Question:

What challenges do volunteers face?

Response:

There is often a lack of information about pickup and delivery locations.